

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 8 6 4

♥ 9 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ 9 4

♠ 5 2

♥ A 7 3

♦ K 10 4 3

♣ K J 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7 3

♥ J 10 8 5

♦ J 6

♣ Q 10 8 7 3

♠ A 10 9

♥ K Q 6 4

♦ A 9 5 2

♣ A 5

West

2 ♠

Pass

All Pass

3NT by South

North

Pass

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

Partner's 1NT overcall shows 15-18 points and guarantees a ♠ stop. With 11 points and no 4-card ♥ suit you say 3NT.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠ K. Do you hold up or not?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 8

You need just one more winner. It could come from a finesse of the ♣ J. It could come from a 3-3 ♥ split. It could come by establishing a fourth card in ♦ s.

Most important for now is the ♠ lead? Do you hold up?

Yes you should hold up. In fact you might as well hold up twice since you aren't contemplating a throw-in of West. Holding up twice will protect you in the unlikely event that West made his 2 ♠ bid with a 5-card suit.

Both the ♥ possibility and the ♣ possibility will either work or not, so you can save them for later. Your highest percentage chance is the fourth ♦, but here you must be careful. You must try to establish the ♦ s without allowing West to get the lead. It is actually pretty easy. Just play a small ♦ from your hand and when West plays low insert the ♦ 10. East wins the ♦ J but cannot harm you with his return.

When the remaining ♦ s fall you have established your ninth trick.

Suppose West inkles out what you are trying to do and inserts his ♦ Q when you play the low ♦ toward dummy?

If he does that he hands you all four ♦ tricks!

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 5
 ♥ K 10 4
 ♦ J 10 9 5
 ♣ J 7 4

♠ J 9 8 6 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 6 2

♣ A Q

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7

♥ Q J 9 6 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ K 10 5 3

♠ A 10 2

♥ A 8

♦ A K 7 3

♣ 9 8 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠		
All Pass			

3♠ by South and another ♠ you could go down. Remember that you only counted one ♥ loser - that means you MUST ruff a ♥ in your hand.

Win the ♦ lead and play ♥ A and another ♥ before you touch trumps.

After this there is nothing the defense can do to stop you ruffing one ♥ in your hand.

Just suppose for an instant that you had played ♠ A and another.

West would have taken the second ♠, then pulled your last ♠. When the ♣ finesse failed you would make only 8 tricks.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer; you respond 2♠.

Partner now bids 3♠.

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Partner now bids 3♠.

Partner tells you that he has only invitational strength, but has at least 6 ♠s. The ♠s are fine by you, but with only 15 HCP you decide to pass.

South plays 3♠. West leads the ♦ J. UhOh. Maybe you should have bid game.

Loser List: ♠ = ? : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = ?

If the ♠s are 2-2 there will be only one loser in that suit. And maybe the ♣ finesse will work.

Don't get too optimistic too early. If you play ♠ A

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4
 ♥ A 10 9 8
 ♦ Q J 10 8
 ♣ J 8 3

♠ K Q 8 6 3

♥ 6 2

♦ K 7 3

♣ K 6 2



♠ J 9 5 2
 ♥ Q J 5
 ♦ 9 2
 ♣ 10 9 7 4

♠ A 10

♥ K 7 4 3

♦ A 6 5 4

♣ A Q 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South

Winner List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 8

With 12 points and a 5-card Major you transfer partner to that Major. You bid 2♥. Partner bids 2♠. Now what do say next?

With 12 points and a 5-card Major you transfer partner to that Major. You bid 2♥. Partner bids 2♠. Now what do say next?

You must insist on game, but since partner could have a doubleton ♠ you do so by bidding 3NT to give him the choice.

He chooses 3NT by passing.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♦ Q. Do you win the first trick or holdup?

A holdup wouldn't hurt you since West would retain the lead. But it probably wouldn't help you much either since you do have 2 stoppers in the suit. You obviously need to establish at least one more winner in ♠s so you won't have to depend on the ♥ A being with East. Need it be said that ♥s is the suit you are worried about and East is the Danger hand? Let's say you win the first trick with dummy's ♦ K.

Suppose you play ♠ A, then ♠ K Q. If they split 3-3 you will be soooo happy because you will make at least 10 tricks. But if East shows out on the third ♠ you will be pretty happy because you can give up a ♠ to West and still make at least 9 tricks. But if West shows out on the third ♠ you could be in deep trouble. You would have to give East the lead to establish an extra ♠ winner, and he might very well lead through your ♥ K.

There is a great safety play to protect against a 4-2 ♠ split. Play a low ♠ from dummy and finesse the ♠ 10. West may win with a doubleton ♠ J but you will still make the contract.

With this layout the safety play finesse actually works and you make an overtrick.

But visualize the ♠ J and ♠ 7 transposed. If you don't make the safety play it is true that the ♠ J will fall. BUT, East will still take the fourth ♠ and when he gets in he will return the ♥ Q.